



Writing a Cover letter and applying for a job

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION AND ETHICS (HS-208)

(WEEK-12)

BY MS. FIZZA HAIDER



What is a Cover Letter?

- ▶ A cover letter is a one-page document that you submit as part of your job application (alongside your CV or Resume).
- ▶ Its purpose is to introduce you and briefly summarize your professional background. On average, your cover letter should be from 250 to 400 words long.
- ▶ A good cover letter can spark the HR manager's interest and get them to read your resume.
- ▶ A bad cover letter, on the other hand, might mean that your application is going directly to the paper shredder. So, to make sure this doesn't happen, it's essential to know how to write a convincing cover letter.

Let's Look at this video!





Format of a cover letter

- Header - Input contact information
- Greeting the hiring manager
- Opening paragraph - Grab the reader's attention with 2-3 of your top achievements
- Second paragraph - Explain why you're the perfect candidate for the job
- Third paragraph - Explain why you're a good match for the company
- Formal closing.

1. Contact Details

2. The Hiring Manager / Department Information

3. Opening Paragraph

Make it personal and tailor it for each job application to grab the reader's attention.

4. The Body

Describe what are your major achievements and how will you help them solve their current challenges. Mention why you are the right person for the job

5. Closing Paragraph

6. Formal Salutation

John Doe
Digital Marketer

john.doe@gmail.com
202-555-0166
New York, USA
john-blog.com
linkedin.com/in/john.doe
@john.doe

To:
Elba Solutions Aps
Erling Kare, CMO
Frederiksberg, Denmark
erling@elbasolutions.dk
21 August, 2019

Dear Mr. Erling Kare,

The creativity and enthusiasm of My Choice: Creative Agency has sparked my enthusiasm to apply and become your next Digital Marketer. My ambitious interest in digital marketing and social media combined with working at your company would be a unique and enriching experience for both parties.

Having more than 4 years of work experience within the Marketing industry, I have developed strong expertise in customer research, social media activation, project management and content creation.

The main achievements that I had in my previous position, that are highly relevant to your specific case and prove the value that I can add to your team, are:

- Increased the conversion from normal users to paying customers from 1,5% to 3,8% in the last year.
- Created over 5 new social media campaigns which increased the engagement (shares and comments) of our users with over 700%.
- Improved the existing strategy to incorporate the latest technological changes to help the organization expand in 3 countries in Northern Europe.
- Researched the differences in consumer behavior for the 3 countries in Northern Europe and created a go-to action plan for each specific one and reached the 1st year targets in the first 10 months.

In addition to this, my internship in a tech start-up for which I was managing independently the whole digital marketing department gave me the perfect insights into your current targeting challenges for expanding in new countries.

Analyzing the target markets, creating social media content and ads for platforms such as LinkedIn, Facebook and Twitter, as well as applying the right communication strategies were the tasks that I took care of and would highly fit your current needs as I already found 3 new ways of reaching new customers for your company through these platforms.

I succeed at working independently as much as I enjoy mutually sharing creative ideas with other team members. Additionally, I am enthusiastic about analyzing market researches as I have an eye for consumer behavior as my previous position has proven.

I will call you next Wednesday in order to follow up on my application at My Choice: Creative Agency and arrange an interview.

Sincerely,
John Doe





How to Write the Perfect Cover Letter (And Get Hired!)

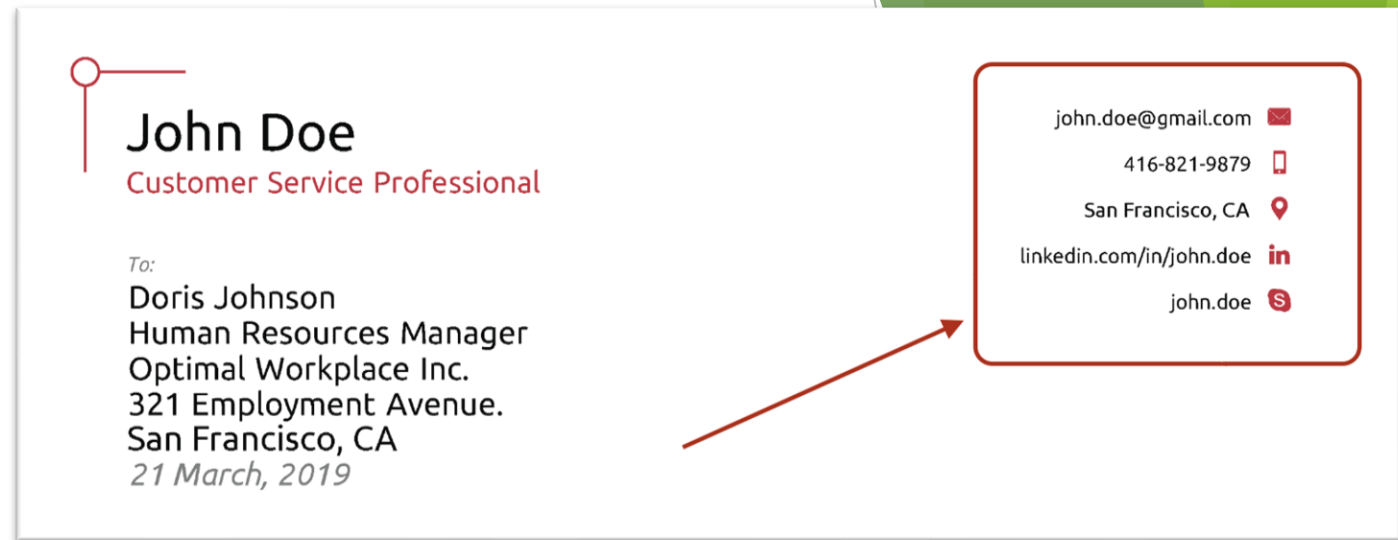
- ▶ **Step #1 - Pick the Right Cover Letter Template**
- ▶ A good cover letter is all about leaving the right first impression.
- ▶ What's a better way to leave a good impression than a well-written, visual template?
- ▶ **Step #2 - Start the Cover Letter with a Header**
- ▶ As with a resume, it's important to start your cover letter with a Contact Information section:

Include all essential information, including:

- ▶ Full Name
- ▶ Phone Number
- ▶ Email
- ▶ Date
- ▶ Name of the hiring manager / their professional title
- ▶ Name of the company you're applying to

In certain cases, you might also consider adding:

- ▶ Social Media Profiles - Any type of profile that's relevant to your field. Social Profiles on websites like LinkedIn, GitHub (for developers), Dribbble (for designers), etc.
- ▶ Personal Website - If you have a personal website that somehow adds value to your application, you can mention it. Let's say you're a professional writer. In that case, you'd want to link to your blog.





Step #3 – Salutation/Greetings

- ▶ The first thing to do here is to address the cover letter to the hiring manager.
 - Dear **[Department]** Hiring Manager,
 - Dear Hiring Manager,
 - To whom it may concern,
 - Dear **[Department]** Team,
- ▶ There are several ways to find out who is the hiring manager. Do a quick lookup on LinkedIn.
- ▶ The simplest option is to look up the head of the relevant department on LinkedIn. Let's say you're applying for the position of a Marketing Assistant at XYZ Company. The hiring manager is probably Head of Marketing or Chief Marketing Officer.



Step #4 - Write an Attention-Grabbing Introduction

- ▶ First impressions matter, especially when it comes to your job search.
- ▶ Recruiters get hundreds, sometimes even thousands, of applications. Chances are, they're not going to be reading every single cover letter end-to-end.
- ▶ So, it's essential to catch their attention from the very first paragraph.

Wrong Example

- ▶ Hey, my name is Ali and I'd like to work as a Sales Manager at XYZ Inc. I've worked as a sales manager at ABC Company Inc. for 5+ years, so I believe that I'd be a good fit for the position.

Correct Example

- ▶ Dear Mr. Salim,
- ▶ My name is Ali Arif and **I'd like to help XYZ Inc. hit and exceed their sales goals** as a Sales Manager. I've worked with Company ABC, a fin-tech company, for 3+ years. As a Sales Representative, **I generated an average of \$30,000+ in sales per month** (beating the KPIs by around 40%). I believe that my previous industry experience, as well as excellence in sales, makes me the right candidate for the job.



Step #5 - Explain why you're the perfect person for the job

- ▶ This is where you show off your professional skills and convince the HR manager that you're a better fit for the job than all the other applicants.
- ▶ But first things first - before you even write anything, you need to learn what the most important requirements for the role are. So, open up the job ad and identify which of the responsibilities are the most critical.
- ▶ The HR manager doesn't only look at whether you'll be good at the job or not. They're looking for someone that's also a good fit for the company culture.
- ▶ Do some research about the company. You want to know things like:
 - What's the company's business model?
 - What's the company product or service? Have you used it?
 - What's the culture like? Will someone micro-manage your work, or will you have autonomy on how you get things done?



Step #6 - Wrap up with a call to action

- ▶ Finally, it's time to finish up your cover letter and write the conclusion.
- ▶ In the final paragraph, you want to:
 - **Wrap up any points you couldn't in the previous paragraphs.** Do you have anything left to say? Any other information that could help the hiring manager make their decision? Mention it here.
 - **Thank the hiring manager for their time.** It never hurts to be courteous, as long as you don't come off as too needy.
 - **Finish the cover letter with a call to action.** The very last sentence in your cover letter should be a call to action. You should ask the hiring manager to take some sort of action.



Step #7 - Use the right formal closing

- ▶ Once you're done with the final paragraph, all you have to do is write down a formal "goodbye" and you're good to go.
- ▶ Feel free to use one of the most popular conclusions to a cover letter:
 - Best Regards,
 - Kind Regards,
 - Sincerely,
 - Thank you,
- ▶ Before sending off the cover letter, make sure to proofread it with software like Grammarly, or maybe even get a friend to review it for you.



Cover Letter Writing Checklist

- ▶ **1) Does your cover letter heading include all essential information?**
 - Full Name
 - Professional email
 - Phone Number
 - Date
 - Relevant Social Media Profiles
- ▶ **2) Did you address the right person? I.e. hiring manager in the company / your future direct supervisor**
- ▶ **3) Does your introductory paragraph grab the reader's attention?**
 - Did you mention 2-3 of your top achievements?
 - Did you use numbers and facts to back up your experience?
- ▶ **4) Did you successfully convey that you're the right pro for the job?**
 - Did you identify the core requirements?
 - Did you successfully convey how your experiences help you fit the requirements perfectly?
- ▶ **5) Did you convince the hiring manager that you're passionate about the company you're applying to?**
 - Did you identify the top 3 things that you like about the company?
 - Did you avoid generic reasons for explaining your interest in the company?
- ▶ **6) Did you finalize the conclusion with a call to action?**
- ▶ **7) Did you use the right formal closure for the cover letter?**

MICHAEL ARNOLD

1 Main Street , London, UK NW80QE | (020) XXXX XXXX | M: | example-email@example.com

Dear Ms. Masters

As a highly skilled Electronics Engineer I read your posting for a new Electronics Engineer with interest. My experience aligns well with the qualifications you are seeking at Masters and Fillmore Electronics in particular my role as Electronics Engineer with PnE Manufacturing and I am certain I would make a valuable addition to your organisation.

With more than 10 years' experience as an Electronics Engineer I am adept in project management design review and diagnostics. Moreover while my on-the-job experience has afforded me a well-rounded skill set including first-rate decision making and problem solving abilities I excel at:

- Increasing manufacturing productivity by reorganising drawing packages.
- Resolving product development and maintenance issues through collaboration.
- Implementing advanced diagnostic tools to resolve customer complaints.
- Collaborating with engineers and customers on projects and products.

In addition to my experience and personal qualities I have a solid educational foundation and a passion for electronics engineering. I am extremely enthusiastic about Masters and Fillmore Electronics' focus on control systems and would welcome the opportunity to contribute to your ongoing growth and success.

Please review my attached resume for additional details regarding my expertise and career achievements. I will follow up to request an appointment to discuss how my experience and background meets your needs.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely

Michael Arnold



Thank you!



Follow Up task:

- ▶ Write your own sample cover letter.
- ▶ Make your LinkedIn profile.